

8.5. Writing to a file

Writing to a file is a major part to know about in file manipulation. Basically, the `fwrite()` function is used to write. To write information into a text file, first open it by using the `fopen()` function. See the code below:

```
$myFile = "testFile.txt";  
$fh = fopen($myFile, 'w');
```

After opening the file, you can use the `fwrite()` command to add data to your file. Look at the example below:

```
<?php  
$file_name = "ourFile.txt";  
$file_Handle = fopen($file_name, 'w');  
$file_Data = "Jane Doe\n";  
fwrite($file_Handle, $file_Data);  
$file_Data = "Bilbo Jones\n";  
fwrite($file_Handle, $file_Data);  
print "Data Written";  
fclose($file_Handle);  
?>
```

After working on the file, close the file using the `fclose` function to keep the document safe. In the above example you can notice that at the end of every data string, we have used `\n`.

8.6. Locking files

If you are through with the input and output operations, lock it immediately. This should be done each time you do an input and output operation if you have opened a file to read and write data. Now, unless you lock this file, the authenticity of the file cannot be maintained. Mere knowledge of reading and learning files can only help when a script is presented to a single user. However, if you want to make your file accessible to multiple users at the same time, PHP4 has provision for this. It provides the `flock()` function with which you can lock your existing document.